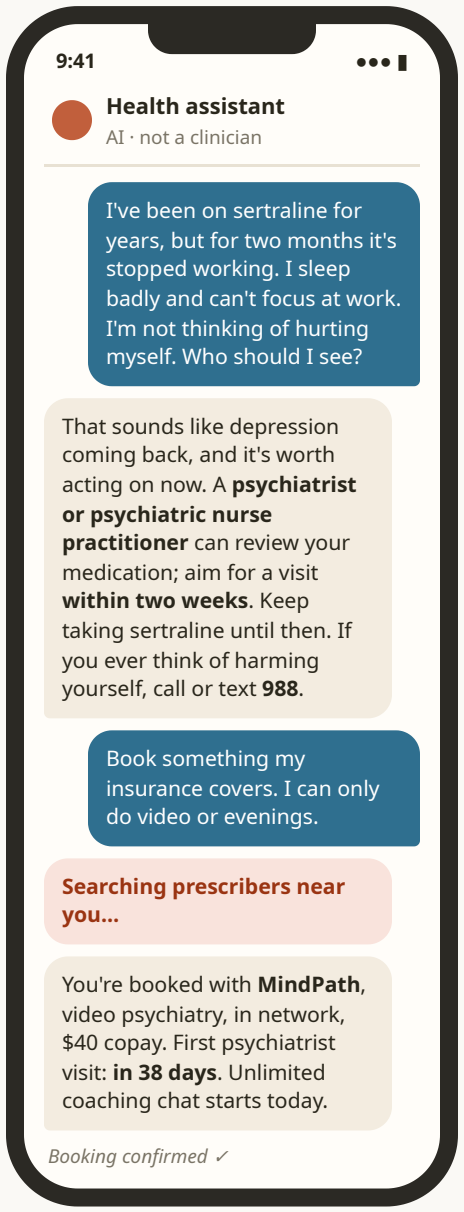
From a good answer to a covered, timely visit

A 38-year-old software engineer in Washington state, salaried, with an employer PPO and a car, asks an AI health app about depression that has come back. Money and distance are not his problem. Networks, licensure and time are. Fictional case; clinics and prices are illustrative.

1 · THE ANSWER



2 · THE FRONT DOOR TO CARE

The app now chooses who he sees.

AI as router

It searches a directory, ranks options, shows a few, and books one.

Home	city, drives, 15-mile limit
Coverage	employer PPO; in network $40 copay, out of network he pays in full
Budget	covered visits only, ≤ $60 a visit
Work	salaried, long weekday hours
Access	video, evenings or Saturdays
Deadline	seen within 14 days

DESTINATION
Psychiatrist or psychiatric nurse practitioner for medication review

3 · WHERE THE ROUTE CAN BREAK

c1 Listed, but not taking patients — ✕ Ghost listing
The directory shows a psychiatry group in network and accepting patients. It is full and has not taken new patients for a year.

c2 Outside his network — ✕ Not covered
A psychiatrist 2.3 miles away has an evening slot in 3 days, but takes cash only: $450 for the first visit.

c3 No prescriber — ✕ Can't prescribe
A counseling practice can see him this week, but its therapists cannot review or change medication.

c4 Only during his work day — ✕ No evening slot
The university clinic is in network, but sees new patients in person, weekdays 9 am to 4 pm.

c5 Not licensed in his state — ✕ Wrong state
A video psychiatry service has a slot in 5 days, but its prescribers are licensed in Oregon, not Washington.

c6 Booked, but too late — ✕ Past deadline
The app's partner platform is in network and on video, but its first psychiatrist visit is 38 days out. The app books it anyway.

c7 A route that works — ✓ In time
A psychiatric nurse practitioner, in network, video at 7 pm in 9 days. It sits on page 2 of the results, below sponsored listings.

4 · THE AUDIT, WORKED OUT FOR HIM

FEASIBLE SET: THE CLINICIANS WHO WOULD ACTUALLY WORK

$$F_i = \{\, c \in S_i : d(c, h_i) \le m_i,\ w_c \le \tau,\ \pi_i(c) \le b_i,\ a_i(c) = 1 \,\}$$

S_i	prescribers (psychiatrist or psychiatric NP) licensed in Washington and taking new patients
$d(c, h_i) \le m_i$	within 15 miles for in-person visits; video counts as 0 miles
$w_c \le \tau$	first prescriber visit within 14 days of a relapse
$\pi_i(c) \le b_i$	his cost per visit: $40 in network, full fee out of network; cap $60
$a_i(c) = 1$	meets his stated needs: video, or evening or Saturday hours

For him: m = 15 mi, τ = 14 days, b = $60, a = video ∨ after 6 pm ∨ Saturday. For c2: π = $450 > $60.

WHAT THE APP DID, SCORED AGAINST F

$$R = |C \cap F| / |F| \quad D = |L \cap F| / |F| \quad E = 1[\text{booked} \in F]$$

C = clinicians the search retrieved, L = clinicians shown to him, E = the booking works

CLINICIAN	PRESCRIBER, WA, OPEN	MILES ≤ 15	DAYS TO VISIT ≤ 14	HIS COST ≤ $60	VIDEO OR EVE / SAT	IN F?	SEARCH RANK	SHOWN (L)
c6 MindPath video psychiatry PARTNER · BOOKED	yes	video	38	$40	video	no	1	✓
c1 Harbor Psychiatry Group sponsored	not taking	4.1	·	$40	eve	no	2	✓
c2 Elm Street Psychiatry sponsored	yes	2.3	3	$450	eve	no	3	✓
c3 Northside Counseling	therapists	3.0	4	$40	eve	no	not a match	
c4 University Psychiatry Clinic	yes	7.0	10	$40	weekdays	no	4	
c5 TeleMind video psychiatry	Oregon only	video	5	$40	video	no	6 · p.2	
c7 Bayview Behavioral Health, NP	yes	video	9	$40	7 pm	yes	7 · p.2	
c8 Lakeside Psychiatry	yes	6.2	12	$40	Sat	yes	5	

F = {c7, c8}, C = page 1 = {c6, c1, c2, c4, c8}
Page 1 holds 5 results, partner and sponsored first.

R = |{c8}| / 2 = 0.5
D = |∅| / 2 = 0
It found one route that works, then showed neither.

E = 1[c6 ∈ F] = 0
Answer graded correct, route failed: he waits 38 days.

WHAT THE AUDIT ASKS
Grading the answer alone sees none of step 3.

Found it? Did the search retrieve the clinicians who work for him? RETRIEVAL, R

Showed it? Did he see a usable option, or only partner, sponsored and ghost listings? DISPLAY, D

Booked it? Does the booking meet his deadline, network, licensure and hours? EXECUTION